

Blogs can be used as highly strategic desktop tools that are here for the long term. In addition to putting down your thoughts and creating a corporate presence, think of the potential for your e-newsletter strategies:

- Articles within newsletters can be linked to a blog, extending life and creating a massive conversation giving you a clearer idea of what your customer is really thinking
- You can offer a bi-directional forum to customers to get true, personal opinions on your products and services; something no survey with just numbers can guarantee
- Company experts can start a blog and become industry experts, helping your company edge out the competition. This, however, will need a great deal of work to go in the background.
- You can layer your blog with editorial controls and ensure nothing you wouldn't want ever goes up there!

5.4 Exploitation Of Blogs

Since its birth and over the last few years when it has grown in stature and reach, the Internet has become all-encompassing to the extent that we are more likely to say "Google it" than "let's check out the library" if we are looking for information.

Despite this, though, we still haven't dreamed of all the ways we'll use it five years from now. But there are certainly indications that we're going to have to be vigilant in recognising the difference between honest business practice and the misuse of the net.

With blogs, since everyone has opinions, and we all now get a chance to offer our opinions up to worldwide scrutiny, we've recognised that it offers us an easy way to achieve our 15 minutes of fame! Guaranteed? Not quite.

Most people are using their newfound recognition to offer up their best: their interesting opinions, their hidden theories, their